AGENTIC CODING · STUDENT SETUP GUIDE

GETTING SET UP

Everything you need in place for day one — accounts, laptop, and software.

KICKOFF: MONDAY, JULY 20 · 6:00–8:00 PM · LIVE ON ZOOM

DAY ONE · WHAT TO EXPECT

Monday is an intro & setup session

The first live block is a welcome session, not a lecture you can fall behind in. We'll walk through how the course works, tour **D2L Brightspace** (the online platform where every video, lesson, and lab submission lives), and then set up every laptop together — installing **VS Code**, adding the right extensions, and getting Windows machines scheduled for **WSL** (Ubuntu Linux). Nobody needs anything installed beforehand: the whole point of Monday is making sure everyone leaves with a working environment and access to everything the course uses.

Join on Zoom: templejc-edu.zoom.us/j/85627136277 · Meeting ID: 856 2713 6277

Have ready: your laptop · its charger · the password you use to log in to it (installs will ask for it) · your D2L login

YOUR BEFORE-MONDAY CHECKLIST

- [ ] **Complete the pre-course survey** — **tktechventure.com/agentic-coding** (5 minutes). It tells us exactly what machine you're bringing so Monday runs smoothly.
- [ ] **Log in to D2L Brightspace** and confirm you can see the **Agentic Coding** course. This is where the whole course happens — if you can't get in, email the instructor before Monday so it's fixed by day one.
- [ ] **Check your laptop** against the requirements on page 2 — 8 GB RAM, 30 GB free disk, and the ability to install software (administrator rights).
- [ ] **Know your computer's login password.** We'll be installing software Monday, and your machine will ask for it. Locked-down work laptops are a problem — flag them early.
- [ ] **Optional head starts:** create a free **GitHub** account at github.com (needed by week 10), and confident Windows users can pre-install **WSL2** at home (page 3) — it needs a reboot, which is why we don't do it in class.

ACCOUNTS & ACCESS YOU'LL USE

THE COURSE PLATFORM · CHECK BEFORE MONDAY

D2L Brightspace — your LMS

Every concept video, lesson, and lab lives in D2L, and submitting each lab unlocks the next lesson — labs, not attendance, drive your progress. **Before Monday:** log in with your Temple College credentials and confirm the Agentic Coding course appears. Can't get in? Email the instructor right away.

DO FIRST · 5 MINUTES

Pre-course survey

tktechventure.com/agentic-coding — tells us your machine and operating system so we can prep for it.

FREE · NEEDED BY WEEK 10

GitHub account

Create one at **github.com** whenever you like. We'll connect it with SSH keys in Module 04 (Git & GitHub).

PROVIDED · NOTHING TO SIGN UP FOR

College AI server

The AI coding assistant runs on the college's own server; details come in Module 05. **No ChatGPT, Claude, or cloud subscription — ever.**

PROVIDED · HANDED OUT IN CLASS

College Linux server (SSH)

Mac students (and anyone whose machine can't run WSL) get login details for the college's Linux server during Module 00. Nothing to do beforehand.

WHAT YOUR COMPUTER NEEDS

Everyone: a 64-bit laptop with **8 GB RAM** (16 GB recommended), **30 GB free disk**, reliable internet, and **administrator rights** to install software. **No GPU required** — the AI runs on college hardware.

WINDOWS

WINDOWS 10 / 11 + WSL2

- **Windows 10** (version 2004 / build 19041 or later) or any **Windows 11**.
- **WSL2 with Ubuntu** — installed in Module 00 (or at home, page 3). Expect one reboot.
- Hardware **virtualization enabled** in BIOS/UEFI (usually already on).
- **Fallback:** if WSL2 won't work, do the whole course over SSH into the college's Linux server.

MAC

MACOS — APPLE SILICON OR INTEL

- **macOS 12 Monterey or later** — Apple Silicon (M1–M4) and Intel Macs are both fine.
- Uses the **built-in Terminal** — no WSL or extra setup needed for a Unix shell.
- VS Code, Docker Desktop, and all developer tools install natively.
- For Ubuntu-specific drills (`apt`, services), you'll SSH into the college's Linux server.

Not supported: Chromebooks and tablets (including iPads) — this course needs a laptop you can install software on. If that's your situation, email the instructor before Monday and we'll figure out an option.

THE SOFTWARE — WHAT INSTALLS WHEN

You install almost everything **together, in class, at the moment the course needs it** — nothing below is homework; it's just the road ahead.

WHEN	WHAT	NOTES
Week 1 · Monday	**VS Code** + Python & Docker extensions	Installed together at the kickoff. Free, Windows & Mac.
Week 1–2	**WSL2 + Ubuntu** (Win) · **Remote-SSH**	WSL needs a reboot, so it's finished at home; Mac students set up SSH instead.
Module 02 · wk 5	**Docker Engine**	Until then the Docker sidebar in VS Code says "failed to connect" — **that's normal**.
Module 03 · wk 7	**Python venv + FastAPI**	Python 3 is already on Ubuntu; we add virtual environments and pip installs.
Module 04 · wk 10	**Git config + GitHub SSH keys**	Git ships with Ubuntu — we configure it and connect your GitHub account.
Module 05 · wk 13	**Continue.dev** AI extension	Connected to the college AI server. Please don't install it early.
Module 06 · wk 16	**Node.js via nvm**	For the HeroUI/Next.js frontend and your capstone.

OPTIONAL HEAD START #1 — INSTALL VS CODE (ALL STUDENTS, ~5 MIN)

1. Go to **code.visualstudio.com** and download the installer for your system.
2. Run it and accept the defaults. If it offers to "sign in to sync settings," you can **skip that**.
3. That's it — don't install any extensions yet; we do that together Monday.

OPTIONAL HEAD START #2 — INSTALL WSL2 + UBUNTU (CONFIDENT WINDOWS USERS, ~20 MIN + REBOOT)

1. Right-click the Start button → **Terminal (Admin)** or **PowerShell (Admin)**.
2. Type `wsl --install` and press Enter, then **reboot** when asked.
3. After the reboot, Ubuntu asks you to create a **username** (short, lowercase) and a **password** — the password is invisible while you type; that's normal. **Write both down.**
4. If anything goes wrong, stop and bring it Monday — that's exactly what the first sessions are for.

> **Please don't install ahead:** Docker, Continue.dev, or any AI/extension bundles. We install each one together at the right moment, configured the way the course needs it — installing early usually creates cleanup work, not a head start.

TIM CARRENDER

INSTRUCTOR · TEMPLE COLLEGE WORKFORCE DEVELOPMENT × CHIEFOS

Email: tim.carrender@gmail.com · **Live blocks:** Monday + Wednesday, 6:00–8:00 PM

Stuck on anything in this guide? Email with "Agentic Coding" in the subject — or just bring it Monday.

PRE-COURSE SURVEY
tktechventure.com/agentic-coding